Q. Why have you sub-titled your new album *Shakkar* #SongsAboutStayingAlive WhenYouDon'tWantTo?

It was written during a phase when I was not keen on being alive. I was fighting this phase of depression and absolute loss of direction. I could have written dark and sad songs, reflecting the emotion of the moment, but the idea was to write songs as an antithesis to the phase I was going through.

Q. How did you get out of this phase?

I finally [sought] therapy. It was very beautifully designed by two therapists who work as a team, one as a spiritual healer and the other in cognitive behavioural therapy. [Playing] Lollapalooza [in Mumbai this January also] changed the game for me. The set went down so well, and there was so much love around me, I went back home [to Bengaluru], and just felt right in my head. We didn't stop recording for the next 10 to 12 days.

Q+A

BITTER PILLS, SWEET REWARDS

Folk-fusion rock singer-songwriter **Raghu Dixit**'s long-awaited new album *Shakkar* was made during the most difficult phase of his life

Q. What triggered your feeling that way?

There was a series of things that happened one after the other. I couldn't believe that so many things could go wrong. It was a culmination of all those hitting [me] and my letting them affect me so badly that I didn't want to live anymore. I just couldn't take it. (Dixit was accused of sexual harassment, ended his marriage, and suffered a family tragedy, all within the span of a few years.)



Q. What did you learn about yourself while making the album?

That there's absolutely nothing better than everyone being kind to each other and sharing each other's burdens once in a while. That's the way the world is meant to live.

–with Amit Gurbaxani